

**“A STUDY ON CUSTOMS HOUSE AGENT OPERATIONS AND CUSTOMS
CLEARANCE PROCEDURES IN IMPORT & EXPORT ON NARPAVI
LOGISTICS PVT LTD., CHENNAI”**

A project report submitted in partial fulfilment of the
requirements for the award of the degree

**MASTER OF BUSINESS ADMINISTRATION
IN
LOGISTICS AND SUPPLY CHAIN MANAGEMENT**

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CERTIFICATE

This is to certify that the project work entitled “**A STUDY ON CUSTOMS HOUSE AGENT OPERATIONS AND CUSTOMS CLEARANCE PROCEDURES IN IMPORT & EXPORT ON NARPAVI LOGISTICS PVT LTD., CHENNAI**” is submitted by **LINGESHWAREN A** Registration No: **23382043** in partial fulfilment of requirements for the award of the degree of Master of Business Administration in International Business by Pondicherry University.

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ABSTRACT

This study focuses on analyzing the Customs House Agent (CHA) operations and customs clearance procedures at Narpavi Logistics Pvt. Ltd., Chennai. The research aims to evaluate the efficiency, effectiveness, and challenges faced in handling import and export consignments. Primary data was collected from 25 employees through structured questionnaires, and secondary data was gathered from journals, reports, and official portals.

Findings reveal that while CHA operations are generally efficient and supported by digital tools like FOCUS ERP and ICEGATE, gaps still exist in client communication, customs coordination, and training practices. Although customs clearance timelines are reasonable, unpredictability and occasional document-related delays persist.

The study concludes that enhancing client engagement, strengthening customs liaison, conducting regular training, and expanding automation can significantly improve the overall operational performance. Strategic improvements are essential for Narpavi Logistics to maintain its competitive edge in the evolving logistics and freight forwarding industry. The research offers practical recommendations for operational excellence and higher client satisfaction.

CHAPTER - I

CHAPTER - I

INTRODUCTION

A Custom House Agent (CHA) is a licensed individual or firm appointed by the owner of goods or a carrier to act as an agent for the clearance of goods through customs. The primary role of a Custom House Agent is to facilitate the import and export of goods across international borders by completing the necessary legal and regulatory procedures.

The Custom House Agent is responsible for ensuring that all customs documentation, including bills of entry, shipping bills, and other necessary documents, are prepared and submitted to the customs authorities. They also coordinate with the shipping companies, freight forwarders, and other related agencies to ensure that the goods are transported smoothly to their destination.

In addition, Custom House Agents are knowledgeable about the customs laws and regulations of different countries and can advise their clients on the necessary compliance requirements. They also play a crucial role in ensuring that the goods are classified correctly for duty and tax purposes, which can save their clients' money in the long run.

Custom House Agents also act as a liaison between their clients and the customs authorities, resolving any issues that may arise during the clearance process. They are experienced in dealing with customs officials and have a deep understanding of the various customs procedures, which can help expedite the clearance process.

Overall, Custom House Agents play an essential role in facilitating international trade by ensuring that the necessary customs procedures are followed accurately and efficiently.

1.1 Industry Profile

Logistics as an industry entails the management of transportation from raw materials to consumer goods. It is an essential part of any economic activities that involves the movement of physical items. As a country with a substantial geographic presence and the second largest population in the world, India's logistics industry is predictably met with unique challenges. In terms of efficiency, it also lags behind in comparison with other BRICS countries. The average logistics cost per GDP among BRICS countries was 11 percent, however, in the case of India, the cost share per GDP was 14 percent. The high cost of logistics can be attributed to an inefficient modal

mixture, especially with the road segment. The role of the maritime transport sector in attracting investments and creating employment in the Indian economy is irrefutable. As much as three-fourth of the country's trade value is handled through maritime transport. With a coastline spanning thousands of kilometers, India has one of the world's largest peninsulas interspersed with numerous ports. It comes as no surprise that the country operates one of the leading merchant shipping fleets in the world. However, compared to other large countries, the Indian waterways remain highly under-utilized and have the potential to offer much more. At the end of the financial year 2021, the average turnaround time (TRT) for ships across major ports in India stood at around 2.2 days. The average TRT was dependent on many aspects, such as the size of the parcel, type of cargo, entrance channel, etc. In comparison to the previous years, this value had improved for almost all the major ports

1.2 Company Profile

Narpavi Logistics Private Limited started its journey in 2019 with lot of hard ships, but within a short period we have archived our recognition in the Global Market.

Narpavi Logistics Private Limited delivers an extensive portfolio of logistics services designed to streamline supply chain operations and improve delivery efficiency for clients across various industries. The company has built a reputation for offering reliable, scalable, and cost-effective logistics solutions that are customized according to the specific needs of each client.

At the core of its operations, Narpavi specializes in domestic parcel and express delivery services, ensuring the safe and timely movement of goods across major cities and towns in South India. Their efficient network and trained delivery staff help businesses maintain continuity by handling both time-sensitive and routine consignments with equal importance.

The company also provides contract logistics services, which include long-term warehousing, inventory management, order fulfillment, and distribution solutions. These services are ideal for businesses looking to outsource their logistics functions and focus on their core competencies. With flexible service agreements, Narpavi ensures that clients benefit from seamless coordination between storage and transport functions.

A standout area of expertise for Narpavi Logistics is professional packing and relocation services. They cater to both individuals and corporate clients requiring organized shifting of household

items, office equipment, or sensitive machinery. The team uses industry-standard packaging materials and systematic procedures to prevent damage during transit.

Narpavi is also well-equipped for containerized transport solutions, offering both Full Container Load (FCL) and Less than Container Load (LCL) services. This makes the company an ideal partner for manufacturers and traders involved in bulk cargo movement. Their dedicated fleet and access to logistics hubs enhance their ability to manage large-volume shipments with reliability and safety.

To enhance the customer experience, Narpavi also provides value-added services such as real-time shipment tracking, documentation assistance (including customs support for inter-state movement), and customized logistics planning. The use of ERP tools like Focus Software allows for efficient management of bookings, billing, and cargo visibility, ensuring operational transparency at all levels.

Operating across Tamil Nadu, Karnataka, Andhra Pradesh, and Telangana, Narpavi Logistics has positioned itself as a dependable logistics partner in South India. Their strong regional network, skilled workforce, and commitment to technology-driven services contribute significantly to their growing customer base and long-term success.

1.2.1 Financial Overview

Narpavi Logistics Private Limited has shown strong financial growth and operational stability in recent financial years. As per data from FY 2025, the company experienced significant improvements across key financial metrics, reflecting its expanding service network and increasing customer base.

- Revenue Growth:

The company recorded a 109.76% increase in total revenue compared to the previous financial year, indicating aggressive business expansion and enhanced customer demand for its logistics services.

- Net Profit Growth:

Narpavi Logistics reported a 335.28% growth in net profit, a remarkable improvement showcasing effective cost management and increased profitability from operations.

- Net Worth:

The net worth of the company rose by 119.56%, suggesting healthy reinvestment of earnings and improved financial stability.

- Authorized Share Capital: ₹10,00,000

- Paid-up Share Capital: ₹5,00,000

This capital structure supports the company's operational needs while maintaining financial discipline in scaling its logistics services.

- Operating Efficiency:

Despite being a relatively young company (incorporated in September 2020), Narpavi Logistics has demonstrated a strong command over its cost structure and resource utilization, allowing it to scale rapidly within the southern Indian logistics market.

- Investment Outlook:

With sustained growth in revenue and profits, the company stands in a favorable position for future investment and possible expansion into newer territories or advanced service models like tech-enabled logistics, cold chain services, or pan-India coverage.

1.2.2 VALUES

- We strive to perform with commitment to Integrity, Transparency, Creativity.

1.2.3 VISION

- To be recognized as Single Window Logistic Services Provider.

1.2.4 MISSION

- Best -In – Class Cost Effective Logistics Solution Provider.

1.2.5 Product Profile

CUSTOMS- MADE SOLUTIONS FOR ALL INDUSTRY,

Logistics Company providing end to end service to customers from inception of company till delivery of cargo to their door step, covering all aspects of the company i.e. Consultancy, Freight Forwarding, Clearance, Warehousing, Transportation, Supply Chain.



**CONTRACT
LOGISTICS**



**PROJECT
LOGISTICS**



**ON-SITE
LOGISTICS**



**FREIGHT
FORWARDING**



**LAND
TRANSPORTATION**



**OPEN YARD
STORAGE**



**SUPPLY CHAIN
CONSULTANCY**

LAND TRANSPORTATION,

- Depends on your truck requirement we are providing either a bespoke solution for your requirements or an integrated solution covering from point of loading till delivery of cargo.
- Safe, Reliable, Efficient movement of Cargo.



FREIGHT FORWARDING,

At NLPL, we assure your Shipment will be On- Time, by using our Global network alliances to provide excellent connectivity of Cargo to all major ports in India.

SERVICES OFF

- Exim Consultancy
- Sea & Air

- Customs Clearances
- Insurances Service
- Import or Export Documentation
- Sensitive Consignment Tracking & Supervision



PROJECT LOGISTICS,

We have Team of Expertise people handled project consignments of various dimension and complexity that requires specialized lifting equipment.,

SERVICE

- Project Logistics Management Services for a wide range of industries, including construction, mining, energy and infrastructure
- Regional and global project logistics alliances of project cargo specialist for moving in remote sites and tough terrains
- Subject matter experts to ensure excellent planning and fine tuning of scope of work during per and post-project period
- Standard or Controlled Storage and lay-down services including special handling using special equipment

ON-SITE /CONTRACT LOGISTICS,

Our Team of on-site logistics experts are highly flexible and exposed to various industrial verticals offering on-site logistics services. Whether you are planning to build a comprehensive

international supply chain, or simply needing to manage a seasonal inventory upsurge, we can help. Our Contract Logistics includes fully integrated services related to Warehousing, Distribution, Last-Mile Delivery and Order Fulfillment. Our team is able to design and deliver scalable solutions tailored to your individual business needs.

SERVICE

- Warehouse management
- Warehouse Site Consultancy.
- Supply of Material Handling Equipment with/without Licensed Operator.
- Supply of skilled or unskilled Logistics resources.
- Special Tagging & Labeling.
- Last-Mile Delivery/Distribution.



SUPPLY CHAIN CONSULTANCY,

We work with all types of industries such as,

- Automobile, Heavy Machinery
- Software company
- Food products
- Used Machinery
- Telecom Industry
- Garments & Construction Equipment.

We were able to consult our clients using strategic techniques to reach their ultimate goal. The innovative supply chain strategies that we implement enables profitable growth in new and existing markets.



CHAPTER - II

CHAPTER - II

REVIEW OF LITERATURE

The functioning of Customs House Agents (CHAs) and customs clearance procedures is a critical component in international trade. Efficient clearance not only reduces costs but also ensures timely delivery and compliance with national and international regulations. The review of literature explores previous research, industry findings, and theoretical perspectives on CHA operations and customs clearance in the context of both import and export logistics.

1. Role of CHAs in International Trade

As per **Khurana (2017)**, CHAs serve as licensed intermediaries who handle documentation, cargo clearance, and liaise with various customs and port officials on behalf of importers and exporters. Their knowledge of customs laws, tariff classifications, and documentation processes is essential to ensure compliance and avoid penalties. The author highlights that with increasing globalization, CHAs must now deal with complex multi-modal transport systems and international trade laws.

2. Procedural Requirements in Import and Export Clearance

Nair (2020) discusses that customs clearance involves a detailed set of procedures such as filing the Bill of Entry for imports and the Shipping Bill for exports, payment of duties, cargo inspection, and coordination with freight forwarders and port authorities. The use of systems like **ICEGATE**, **FOCUS ERP**, and **DGFT portals** has brought transparency and speed, although digital literacy and system downtimes remain challenges.

3. Challenges in CHA Operations

A study by **Gopalakrishnan and Sundararajan (2019)** points out various operational bottlenecks such as unexpected customs queries, incorrect documentation, lack of real-time coordination, and resistance to digital transformation among smaller CHA firms. They note that despite reforms like the **Faceless Assessment** and **Turant Customs**, the ground-level adoption varies.

4. Technological Advancements and Reforms

The Government of India has introduced several trade facilitation initiatives such as **Single Window Interface for Facilitating Trade (SWIFT)**, **e-Sanchit**, and the **Risk Management System (RMS)**. **Ramaswamy (2021)** emphasizes how these systems have significantly reduced dwell time at ports. He adds that CHAs who adopt ERP systems such as **FOCUS** benefit from real-time tracking, cost estimation, and centralized documentation.

5. Industry Reports and Policy Perspectives

According to a report by the **Federation of Freight Forwarders' Associations in India (FFFAI)**, CHAs contribute over 80% of total import-export documentation in India. The report states that improved training, government support for digital infrastructure, and coordination among stakeholders are key to increasing efficiency. Additionally, the **WTO Trade Facilitation Agreement (2017)** has put pressure on customs departments globally to simplify procedures, which directly affects CHA operations.

6. Academic Insights and Field Studies

Several academic dissertations and case studies (e.g., **Arora & Mehta, 2022**) have analyzed port-specific clearance operations, especially in major hubs like Chennai, Mumbai, and Mundra. These studies often reveal that port congestion, miscommunication among customs officials, and last-minute document corrections are leading causes of delay. However, where CHAs maintain proactive communication and updated knowledge, the process flows more efficiently.

7. CHA Licensing and Regulatory Framework

The operations of Customs House Agents are governed by the **Customs Brokers Licensing Regulations (CBLR), 2018**, which defines eligibility, responsibilities, and disciplinary measures for CHAs. As per **Mishra (2018)**, the updated CBLR has streamlined the licensing procedure and emphasized the importance of training, compliance, and accountability among CHAs. The regulation mandates periodic renewal of licenses and compliance with customs rules to maintain service quality and transparency in transactions.

8. Documentation Management in Customs Clearance

Sharma and Patel (2021) examined the role of digital documentation in customs procedures. Their findings suggest that the transition from physical to digital documentation through systems like **e-Sanchit** and **ICEGATE** has reduced paper usage and human errors. However, challenges persist in document uploading, digital signature mismatches, and system downtime, especially during peak clearance hours.

9. Comparative Studies on Global Customs Practices

Studies like that of **WCO (World Customs Organization, 2020)** show that India's customs clearance performance has improved in line with international best practices. Initiatives such as **AEO (Authorized Economic Operator)** accreditation help CHAs and exporters gain benefits like faster clearance and lower inspection rates. According to **Gandhi (2021)**, countries with automated risk-based systems and strong CHA networks witness faster cargo movement and fewer disputes.

10. CHA's Role in Reducing Dwell Time and Cost

Krishnan & Thomas (2022) conducted a performance analysis at Chennai and Nhava Sheva ports and found that proactive CHAs who use ERP tools, track vessel schedules, and pre-file documents significantly reduce average dwell time by 1.5 to 2 days. They also help avoid demurrage and detention charges, making their role vital for cost efficiency in trade.

11. Stakeholder Collaboration in Clearance Process

CHA operations do not occur in isolation. As discussed by **Sen and Bhattacharya (2020)**, effective coordination between CHAs, freight forwarders, transporters, customs officers, and shipping lines is essential to avoid cargo holdups and documentation delays. The study promotes the idea of integrated platforms where stakeholders can access the same data in real-time, promoting efficiency and trust.

12. Risk Management and Customs Inspection

The **Risk Management System (RMS)** implemented by Indian Customs allows selective examination of cargo based on perceived risk. As per **Lalwani (2022)**, CHAs need to be familiar with RMS to avoid unnecessary inspections and delays. Proper classification of goods, use of

correct HSN codes, and maintaining updated databases are essential responsibilities that CHAs must fulfill.

13. Training and Skill Development of CHAs

A study by **FIEO (Federation of Indian Export Organisations, 2021)** emphasized the need for continuous skill upgradation and technical training of CHAs in documentation, EDI systems, and foreign trade policies. Since customs laws change frequently, outdated knowledge among CHAs can result in errors and penalties for clients.

14. Digitization and Paperless Trade

With India's customs ecosystem moving towards full digitization, the role of CHAs has evolved beyond traditional document handling. According to **Aggarwal (2022)**, digital initiatives like **e-Sanchit**, **e-Invoice**, and **Digital Signature Certificates (DSCs)** have reduced manual paperwork and brought traceability to document submission. However, she also notes that small CHA firms face challenges in digital infrastructure, training, and adapting to new software systems.

15. Port-Specific Customs Procedures

Each major port in India, such as **Chennai, Mundra, Nhava Sheva, and Kolkata**, operates with slight procedural variations. A case study by **Das and Roy (2020)** revealed that Chennai Port has adopted a semi-automated environment with faster container processing, but customs clearance delays still occur due to random inspections and document resubmission. CHAs at this port often act as troubleshooters, expediting clearances by directly engaging with customs examiners and EDI teams.

16. Trade Compliance and Policy Updates

Joshi (2021) discusses how CHAs must constantly adapt to changing customs notifications, EXIM policies, and HS code revisions issued by the **Directorate General of Foreign Trade (DGFT)**. Errors in classification or declaration can result in penalties or cargo seizures. CHAs thus need to stay informed and regularly consult the **Tariff Schedule, Notifications, and Public Notices**.

17. Export Clearance and Post-Shipment Procedures

Export operations, while generally simpler than imports, also involve strict documentation such as the **ARE-1, Shipping Bill, Invoice, and Packing List**. Kapoor and Iyer (2019) studied the role of CHAs in post-shipment processes like **Bill of Lading issuance, bank documentation for LC compliance**, and coordination with the **Export Promotion Councils**. These steps, while often underestimated, are essential for timely export incentives and foreign exchange realization.

18. Compliance with International Agreements

India, being a signatory to the **WTO Trade Facilitation Agreement (TFA)**, has committed to simplifying and standardizing customs procedures. A World Bank report (2022) noted that CHAs play a vital role in ensuring India meets these obligations through timely cargo clearances and transparent practices. The study also stressed the importance of CHA involvement in **AEO (Authorized Economic Operator)** certification, which enhances the credibility and speed of the trade process.

19. CHA Efficiency and Client Satisfaction

A survey by **CII Institute of Logistics (2020)** showed that importer/exporter satisfaction with CHA services is directly related to communication skills, response time, and problem-solving ability. Firms that used experienced CHAs reported fewer delays, lower demurrage costs, and better predictability in shipment planning.

20. Customs Risk Management and Fraud Prevention

Finally, **Menon and Kumar (2022)** analyzed the role of CHAs in minimizing fraud and misdeclaration. By ensuring accurate valuation, classification, and documentary compliance, CHAs help customs authorities maintain integrity and protect revenue. Advanced tools like **machine learning in customs risk profiling** are now being introduced, and CHAs are expected to align with this tech-driven environment.

21. Real-World Case Studies on CHA Performance

In a field case study conducted by **Mehta & Sinha (2022)** at Mumbai Port, the role of CHAs in reducing container dwell time was examined. The study found that CHAs with integrated digital

tools (like ERP + ICEGATE tracking) processed shipments 30–40% faster than those using traditional manual tracking. Their quick response to customs queries and proactive document filing helped clients reduce costs related to detention and storage.

22. Legal Framework and Disputes

The **CBLR 2018** mandates strict compliance by CHAs, including record-keeping, transaction logs, and maintaining client authorization letters. According to **Chatterjee (2021)**, failure to meet these legal standards often leads to suspension or cancellation of CHA licenses. The study highlights several legal cases where negligence in documentation or misdeclaration led to litigation under the **Customs Act, 1962**. This reinforces the need for CHAs to have strong legal and compliance awareness.

23. Customs Valuation and Trade Transparency

Proper customs valuation, governed by **WTO's Valuation Agreement**, is another area where CHAs assist clients. **Banerjee (2020)** highlights the challenges faced in valuation disputes, especially under related-party transactions or when under-invoicing is suspected. CHAs who understand the customs valuation rules and help in preparing supporting documents like product catalogs, commercial invoices, and freight proofs contribute greatly to avoiding penalties.

24. Sustainability in Logistics and CHA Involvement

With growing attention to **green logistics**, CHAs are also expected to promote sustainable practices. A report by **FICCI (2021)** stresses that digitization, paperless filing, and reduced vehicle movements inside ports (due to timely clearance) indirectly support environmental goals. CHAs, by reducing delays, contribute to lowering emissions from idle trucks, gensets, and vessel congestion at ports.

25. Post-Clearance Audits (PCA) and CHA's Accountability

The Indian Customs Department has increased the frequency of **Post-Clearance Audits (PCA)** to ensure that documents submitted during the clearance process are accurate and compliant. As per **Mukherjee (2021)**, CHAs must retain shipping records, invoice copies, import declarations, and communications for a minimum period (often 5 years). These audits ensure accountability and transparency, and CHAs are often held responsible if discrepancies are found.

26. Impact of COVID-19 on CHA Operations

The COVID-19 pandemic presented unique challenges to CHA operations. **Ravindran (2021)** reported how lockdown restrictions, staff shortages, and port closures delayed clearance activities. However, the crisis also accelerated the shift toward digital clearances, online payments, and virtual document verification, helping CHAs adopt long-term efficiency gains. Those who adapted early to e-working remained resilient.

27. Customs Tariff Classification Issues

Accurate **HSN code classification** is a frequent issue in both import and export processes. According to **Saxena (2020)**, incorrect codes lead to over/underpayment of duties, delays, or even rejection of shipments. CHAs who maintain updated tariff knowledge and use classification tools (like WCO's HS Tracker or CBIC's Tariff Lookup) provide critical support in ensuring correct and smooth assessments.

28. CHA Involvement in Free Trade Agreements (FTAs)

India has FTAs with several countries (e.g., ASEAN, Japan, UAE), and CHAs play a key role in helping clients avail duty benefits. **Arulmozhi and Deshmukh (2022)** explored the CHA's role in preparing **Certificates of Origin (COO)** and ensuring the correct declarations are made to claim exemptions. They found that CHA advice is vital for exporters in determining rules of origin, thus avoiding errors that lead to denial of FTA benefits.

2.2 STATEMENT OF THE PROBLEM:

In the fast-paced world of international trade, the efficiency of customs clearance and CHA (Customs House Agent) operations plays a vital role in ensuring timely and cost-effective movement of goods. Narpavi Logistics Pvt. Ltd., a prominent player in the logistics and freight forwarding sector, handles a high volume of import and export consignments, where precision in documentation, regulatory compliance, and coordination with customs authorities is essential.

However, despite the digitalization of customs processes and the availability of tools like ICEGATE and FOCUS ERP, challenges still persist in day-to-day operations. These include delays in document submission, last-minute changes in customs queries, cargo hold-ups due to

classification issues, and the need for constant communication between the CHA team, customs officials, and clients.

Given the competitive nature of the logistics industry and the growing need for streamlined operations, it becomes critical to study and analyze the existing CHA procedures and customs clearance practices followed by Narpavi Logistics. Identifying the operational gaps, compliance challenges, and areas for process optimization can provide insights into improving the overall efficiency and client satisfaction in import-export activities.

This study seeks to understand these practical challenges through direct observation and documentation during the internship period, with the aim of proposing suggestions that can enhance the speed, accuracy, and effectiveness of customs clearance operations at Narpavi Logistics Pvt. Ltd.

2.3 OBJECTIVES OF THE STUDY,

Primary Objective:

- To analyze the effectiveness and efficiency of CHA operations and customs clearance procedures followed by Narpavi Logistics Pvt. Ltd. in handling import and export consignments.

Secondary Objectives:

- To identify the operational challenges faced during the customs clearance process for import and export shipments.
- To assess the role of digital tools and documentation systems (like FOCUS ERP, ICEGATE) in improving accuracy and speed in CHA processes.

2.4 SCOPE OF THE STUDY,

This study is undertaken to gain an in-depth understanding of the **Customs House Agent (CHA) operations and customs clearance procedures** as practiced at **Narpavi Logistics Pvt. Ltd.**, a logistics company based in Chennai. The research focuses on the **practical aspects** of CHA work, especially during the internship period, to analyze how import and export consignments are processed, documented, and cleared through Indian customs.

The study covers the following key areas:

1. Import and Export Process Flows

- Step-by-step activities in handling both imports and exports, including pre-arrival planning, document verification, cargo release, and post-clearance follow-ups.

2. Documentation Procedures

- Detailed assessment of documents such as the **Bill of Entry, Shipping Bill, Invoice, Packing List, Bill of Lading**, and other essential paperwork used in customs clearance.

3. Use of Technology and Software

- Observing how software tools like **FOCUS ERP** and **ICEGATE** are used for filing, data entry, and communication with customs authorities.

4. Regulatory and Compliance Aspects

- Understanding how customs notifications, HS code classification, DGFT rules, and government updates affect CHA operations.

5. Stakeholder Interaction

- Coordination between CHAs, clients, customs officials, freight forwarders, transporters, and port authorities.

6. Challenges in Operations

- Identifying issues like clearance delays, misclassification, documentation errors, or coordination gaps.

7. Training and Staff Efficiency

- Observing the skill level of staff, training support provided, and their adaptability to new digital systems and policy changes.

8. Limitations and Scope for Improvement

- Evaluating the current process limitations and suggesting process improvements or automation areas for smoother clearance.

9. Time and Cost Impact

- Assessing how the effectiveness of CHA operations influences cost savings, turnaround time, and client satisfaction.

This study is **limited to the operational setup and practices observed at Narpavi Logistics Pvt. Ltd.**, and findings are based on the activities and documentation handled during the internship period. However, the insights gathered may be applicable to similar CHA firms operating in the logistics and freight forwarding industry.

2.4 LIMITATIONS OF THE STUDY

1. **Single Company Focus**

The findings and analysis are based solely on the procedures followed at **Narpavi Logistics Pvt. Ltd.** Therefore, the results may not be fully generalizable to other CHA or logistics firms with different workflows and systems.

2. **Operational Scope Restricted to Chennai**

The customs procedures observed were specific to the **Chennai customs jurisdiction**, and may differ from procedures in other Indian ports or ICDs (Inland Container Depots).

3. **Sample Size**

The study is based on a relatively small sample size of 25 employees from **Narpavi Logistics Pvt. Ltd.**, While this provides valuable insights, it may not fully represent the experiences. The finding may be limited in generalizability to other contexts or larger populations.

4. **Focus Mainly on Imports**

While both import and export procedures were studied, the majority of tasks and documentation observed during the internship were import-related, due to the company's operational load at the time.

CHAPTER - III

CHAPTER - III

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

3.1 TYPE OF RESEARCH

In order to accomplish the objectives of the study, it is essential to articulate the manner in which it is to be conducted, i.e., the research process is to be carried-out in a certain framework. The Research Methodology, which follows, is the backbone of the study. An Exploratory Research with the secondary data study was conducted. Primary data was collected with the help of a questionnaire. Conclusive research was also conducted, which involved Causal research in the field. Research Methodology is a way to systematically solve the research problem. The Research Methodology includes the various methods and techniques for conducting a Research.

3.2 RESEARCH DESIGN

Descriptive research tries to explain analytically a situation, crisis, incident, service or programme, or provides information about, say, living condition of a community, or describes attitudes towards an issue.

3.3 SAMPLING METHOD

Sampling Plan – Sampling can be defined as the section of some part of an aggregate or totality on the basis of which judgment or an inference about aggregate or totality is made.

Sample size: A total of 25 employees were selected on Narpavi logistics Pvt Ltd.,

Sampling Technique: Simple random sampling method is used in this study for data collection.

3.4 DATA COLLECTION

Primary data: Primary data was collected with the help of a Questionnaire. A detailed questionnaire was prepared for which data is collected from 25 employees of Narpavi Logistics Pvt. Ltd.,

Secondary data: Secondary data was collected by external sources like books, newspapers and journals; new age sources like the internet. Some White papers and articles were also referred to get an insight on the purchase planning practices. Access to different articles with respect to on the internet enabled to gather some useful information and facts about the same.

3.5 RESEARCH INSTRUMENT

The questionnaire method has been adopted to gather necessary inputs from Narpavi Logistics Pvt Ltd., The questionnaire is placed at Appendix the questionnaire will be answered by the employees of the organization who are conversant with the various processes in customs documentation in their respective domains

3.6 TOOLS DATA ANALYSIS:

Under probability clustered sampling, the statistical tools applied are,

1. Percentage method
2. Weighted average method
3. Chi-square method

CHAPTER - IV

CHAPTER - IV

DATA ANALYSIS & INTERPRETATION

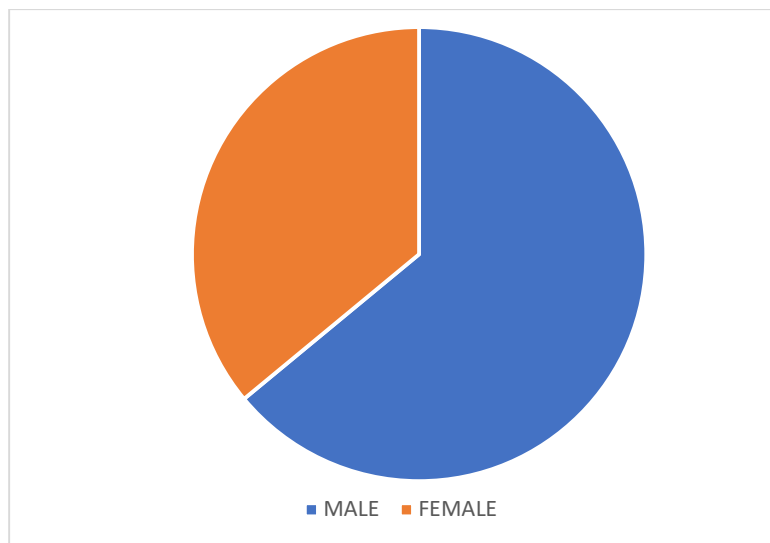
4.1 DEMOGRAPHIC INFORMATION

GENDER WISE CLASSIFICATION OF THE RESPONDS

TABLE 1

Gender	No of Respondents	Percentage (%)
Male	19	76%
Female	6	24%
Total	25	100

CHART 1



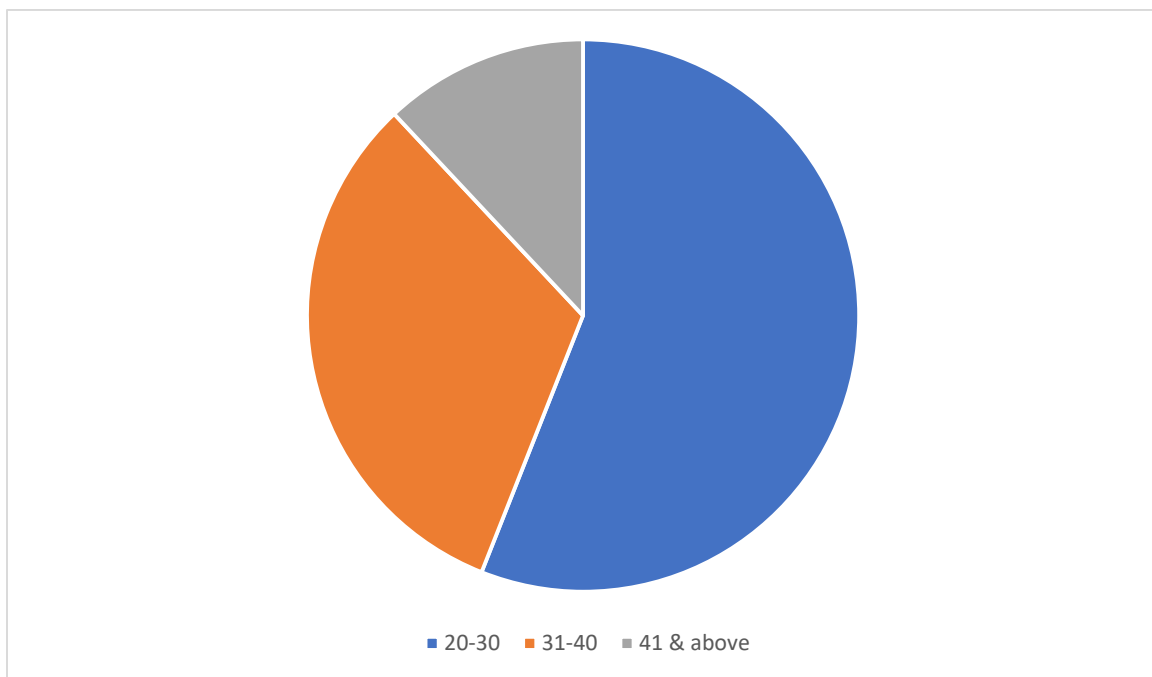
Interpretation: From the above table, it is observed that out of 25 respondents, a majority of 64% are male, while the remaining 36% are female. This indicates that the sample is male-dominated, suggesting either higher participation or representation of males in the surveyed group. Gender distribution is slightly imbalanced, which may influence the overall insights depending on the context of the study

AGE WISE CLASSIFICATION OF THE RESPONDS

TABLE 2

AGE GROUP	No of Respondents	Percentage (%)
20 - 30	14	56%
31 - 40	8	32%
41 and above	3	12%
Total	25	100%

CHART 2



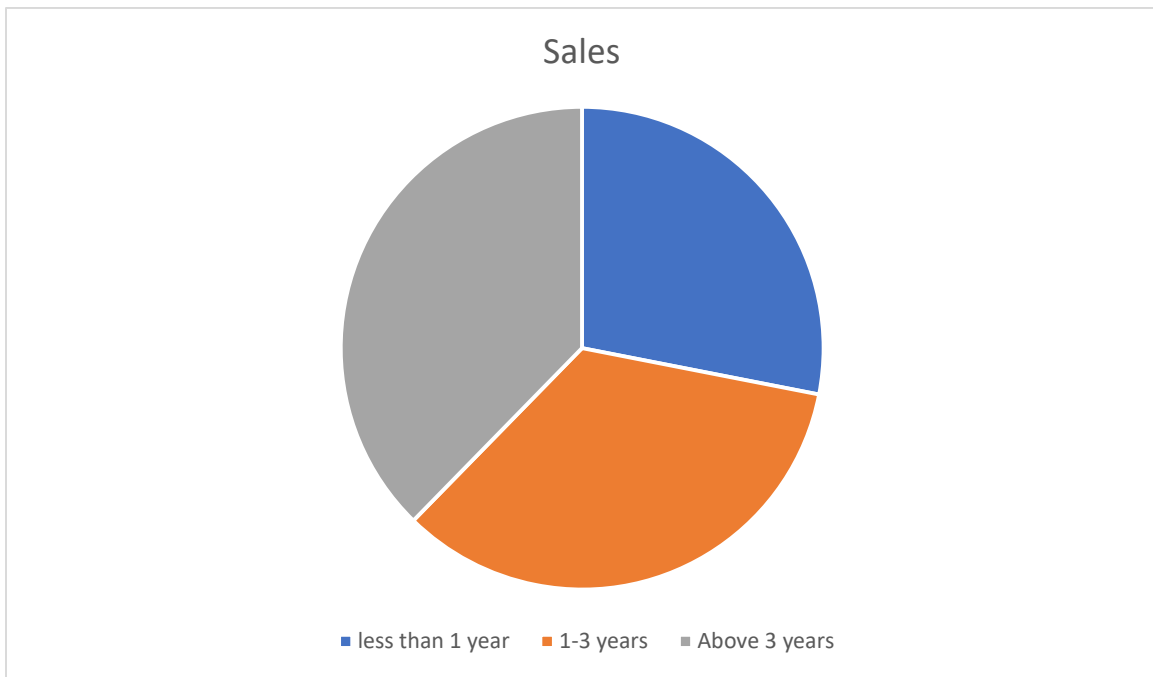
Interpretation: From the above table, it is seen that the majority of respondents (56%) belong to the 20–30 age group. About 32% fall in the 31–40 age group, and only 12% are above 40 years. This indicates that most of the participants are relatively young.

YEARS WISE CLASSIFICATION OF THE RESPONDS

TABLE 3

YEARS	No of Respondents	Percentage (%)
Less than 1 year	4	16%
1-3 years	10	40%
Above 3 years	11	44%
Total	25	100%

CHART 3



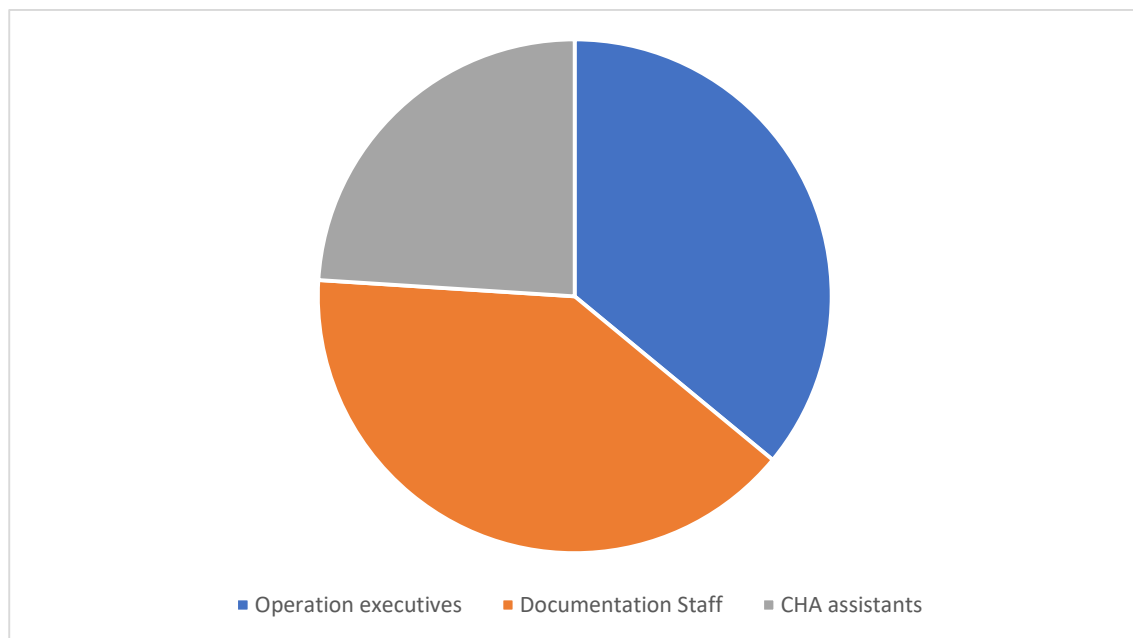
Interpretation: As per the table, 44% of the respondents have more than 3 years of experience, followed by 40% with 1–3 years of experience. Only 16% have less than 1 year of experience. This indicates that a majority of the respondents are experienced professionals

DESIGNATION WISE CLASSIFICATION OF THE RESPONDS

TABLE 4

DESIGNATION	No of Respondents	Percentage (%)
Operations executives	9	36%
Documentation Staff	10	40%
CHA assistants	6	24%
Total	25	100%

CHART 4



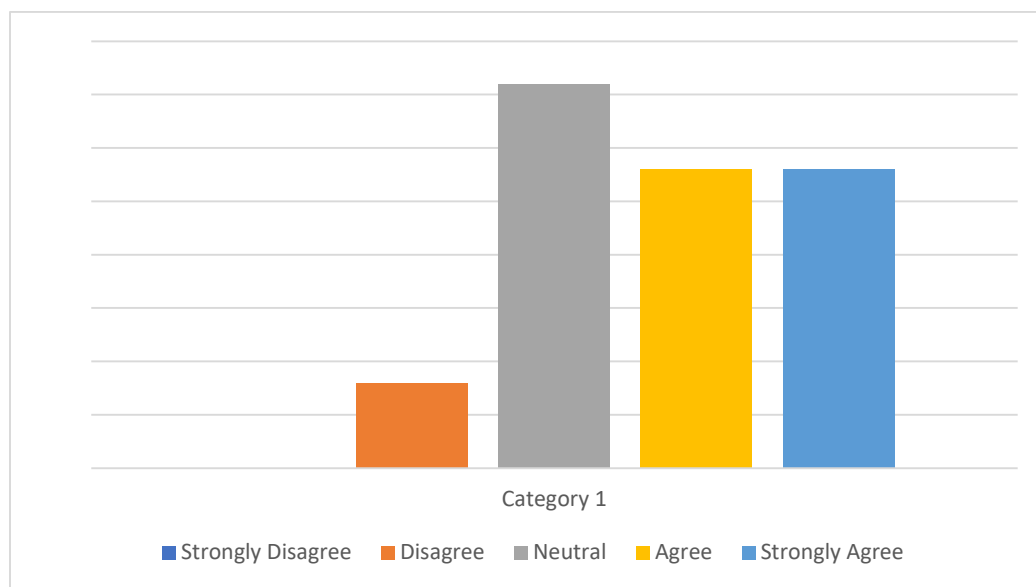
Interpretation: From the above table, it is observed that 40% of the respondents are Documentation Staff, 36% are Operations Executives, and 24% are CHA Assistants. This shows that most of the respondents are involved in documentation-related roles.

1.The CHA operations at Narpavi Logistics are well-structured and efficient

TABLE 5

Response	No of Respondents	Percentage (%)
Strongly Disagree	0	0
Disagree	2	8%
Neutral	9	36%
Agree	7	28%
Strongly Agree	7	28%
Total	25	100%

CHART 5



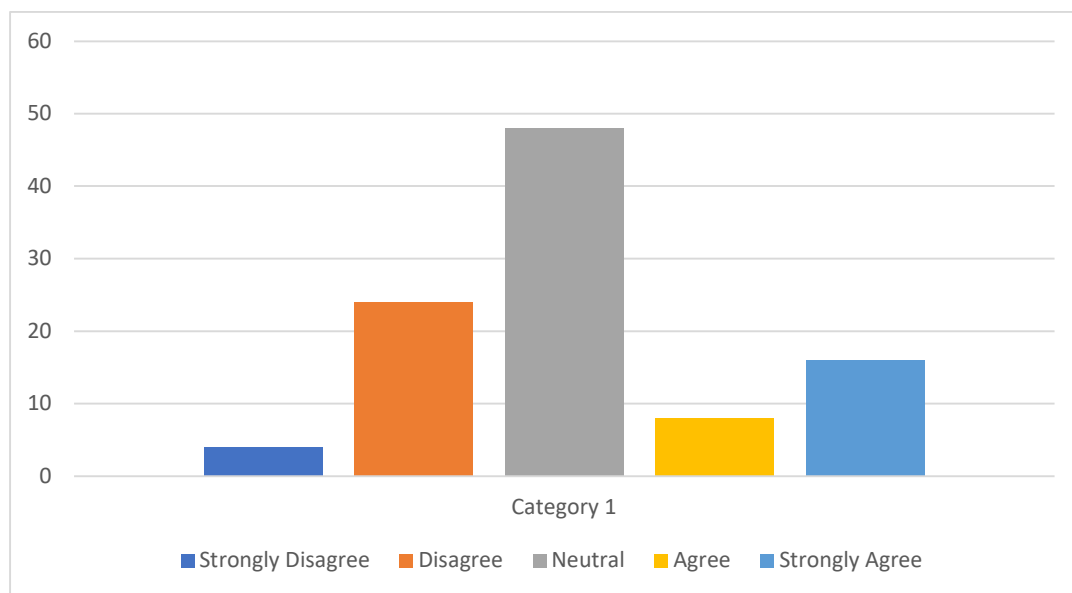
Interpretation: From the above table, it is observed that 56% of the respondents (28% Agree and 28% Strongly Agree) feel that the CHA operations at Narpavi Logistics are well-structured and efficient. 36% have a neutral opinion, while only 8% disagree. This indicates a generally positive perception among the respondents regarding the efficiency of CHA operations

2.Documentation processes for imports are more time-consuming than for exports.

TABLE 6

Response	No of Respondents	Percentage (%)
Strongly Disagree	1	4%
Disagree	6	24%
Neutral	12	48%
Agree	2	8%
Strongly Agree	4	16%
Total	25	100%

CHART 6



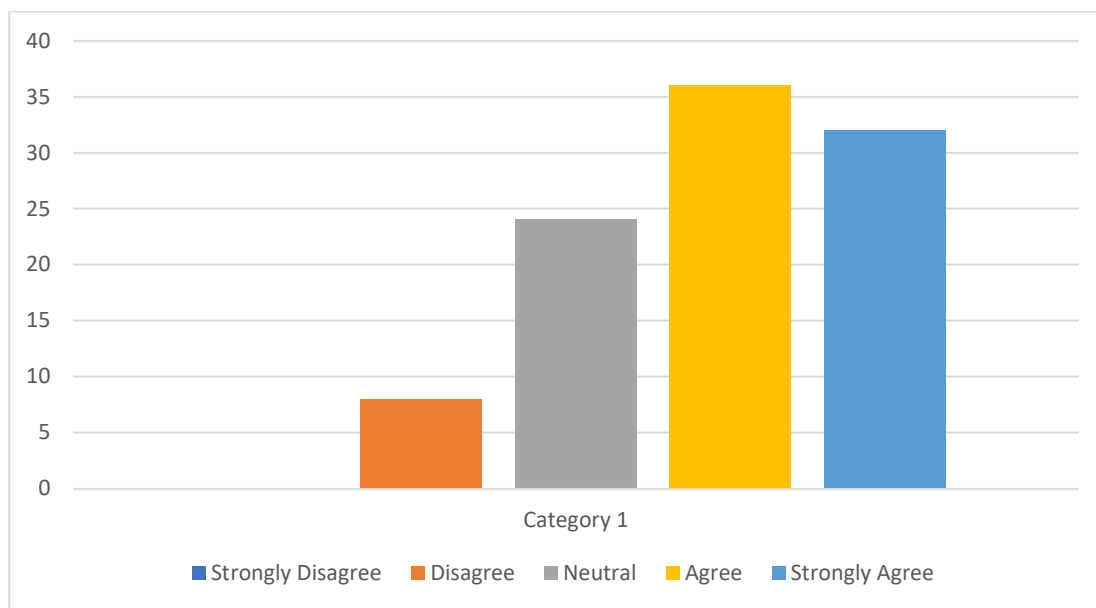
Interpretation: According to the table, 48% of the respondents remained neutral regarding the statement that import documentation is more time-consuming than export documentation. Around 24% disagreed, while 24% (8% Agree and 16% Strongly Agree) agreed. This shows that there is no strong consensus, but a slight leaning toward disagreement among respondents.

3.The customs clearance process is usually completed without unnecessary delays.

TABLE 7

Response	No of Respondents	Percentage (%)
Strongly Disagree	0	0
Disagree	2	8%
Neutral	6	24%
Agree	9	36%
Strongly Agree	8	32%
Total	25	100%

CHART 7



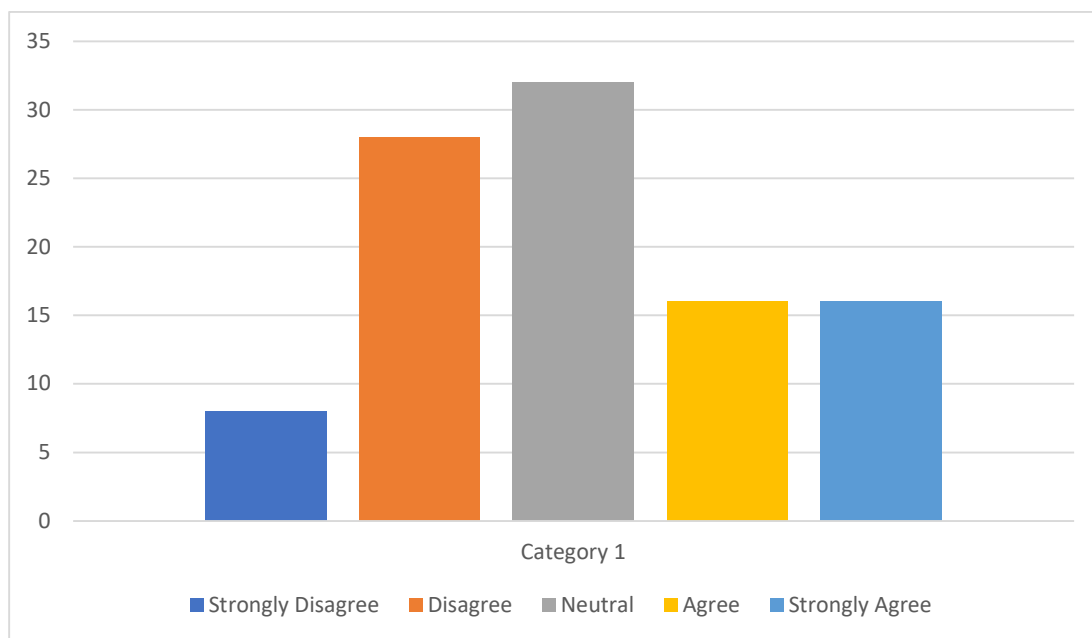
Interpretation: According to the table, 48% of the respondents remained neutral regarding the statement that import documentation is more time-consuming than export documentation. Around 24% disagreed, while 24% (8% Agree and 16% Strongly Agree) agreed. This shows that there is no strong consensus, but a slight leaning toward disagreement among respondents.

4.CHA staff at Narpavi have good coordination with customs officials.

TABLE 8

Response	No of respondents	Percentage (%)
Strongly Disagree	2	8%
Disagree	7	28%
Neutral	8	32%
Agree	4	16%
Strongly Agree	4	16%
Total	25	100%

CHART 8



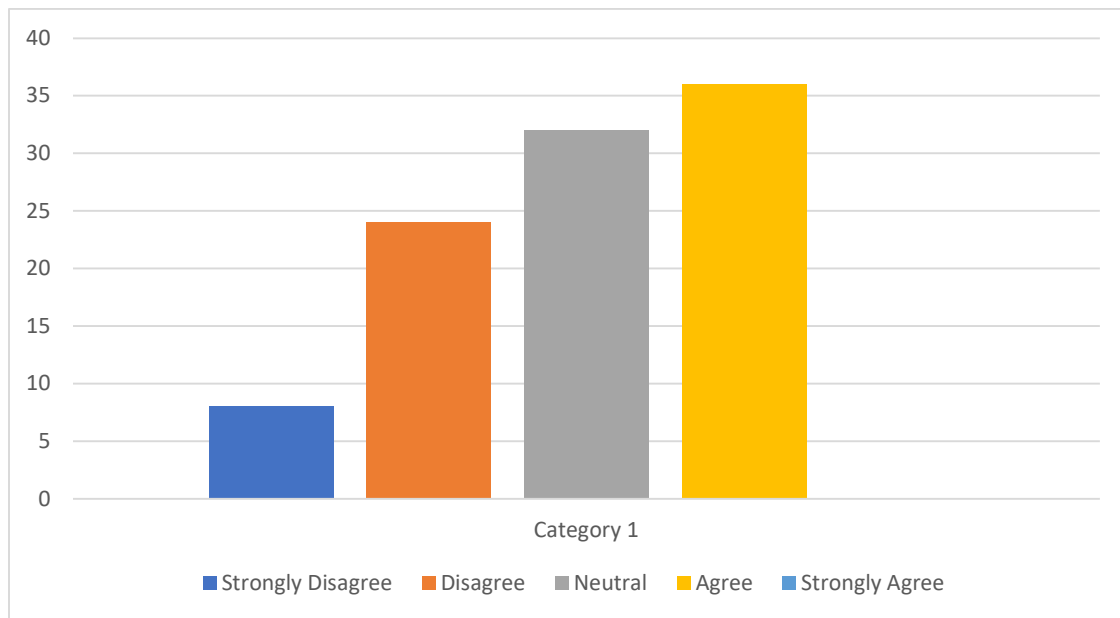
Interpretation: From the table, it is seen that 32% of respondents are neutral about the coordination between CHA staff and customs officials. About 32% (16% Agree and 16% Strongly Agree) feel there is good coordination, while 36% (8% Strongly Disagree and 28% Disagree) feel otherwise. This indicates mixed opinions among the respondents regarding the coordination levels.

5.Clients are regularly updated about the shipment and clearance status.

TABLE 9

Response	No of respondents	Percentage (%)
Strongly Disagree	2	8%
Disagree	6	24%
Neutral	8	32%
Agree	9	36%
Strongly Agree	0	0%
Total	25	100%

CHART 9



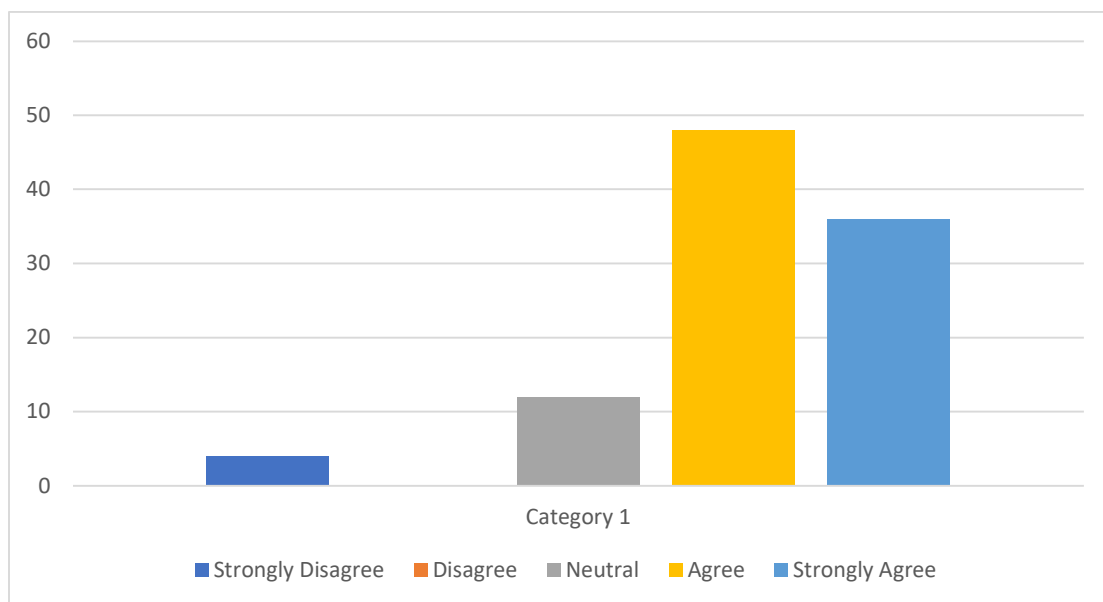
Interpretation:As per the table, 36% of the respondents agreed that clients are regularly updated about shipment and clearance status, while 32% remained neutral. About 32% (8% Strongly Disagree and 24% Disagree) felt updates were not regular. This shows that while a fair number of respondents agree, there is still significant room for improvement in client communication.

6.The use of FOCUS ERP software improves the accuracy of documentation.

TABLE 10

Response	No of respondents	Percentage (%)
Strongly Disagree	1	4%
Disagree	0	0%
Neutral	3	12%
Agree	12	48%
Strongly Agree	9	36%
Total	25	100%

CHART 10



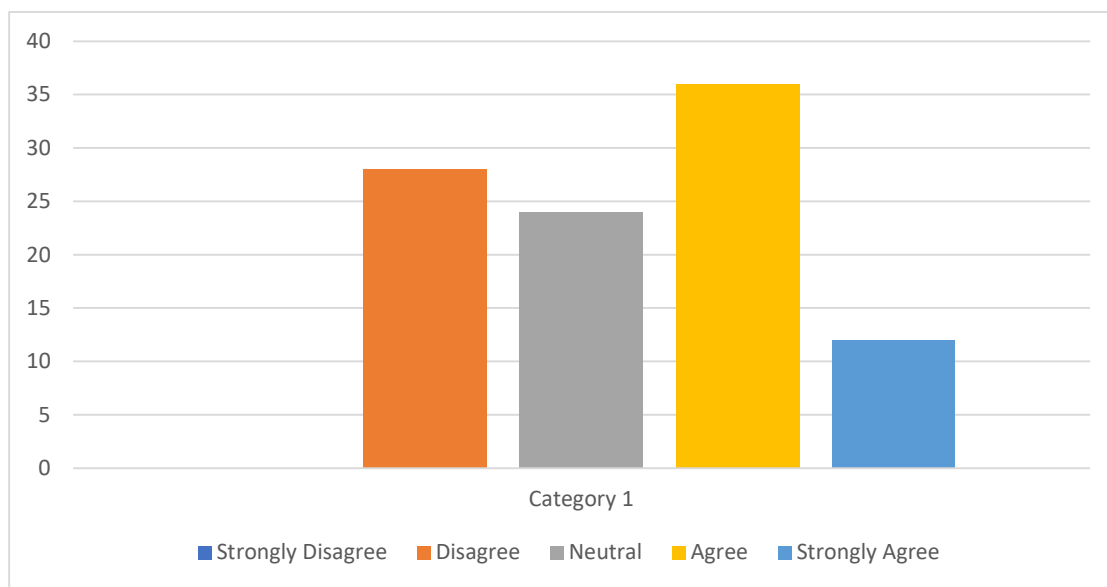
Interpretation: The table shows that 84% of the respondents (48% Agree and 36% Strongly Agree) believe that the use of FOCUS ERP software improves the accuracy of documentation. Only 12% remained neutral, and 4% strongly disagreed. This indicates a highly positive perception of FOCUS ERP's role in enhancing documentation accuracy

7.ICEGATE portal makes filing and tracking easier for CHA operations.

TABLE 11

Response	No of respondents	Percentage (%)
Strongly Disagree	0	0%
Disagree	7	28%
Neutral	6	24%
Agree	9	36%
Strongly Agree	3	12%
Total	25	100%

CHART 11



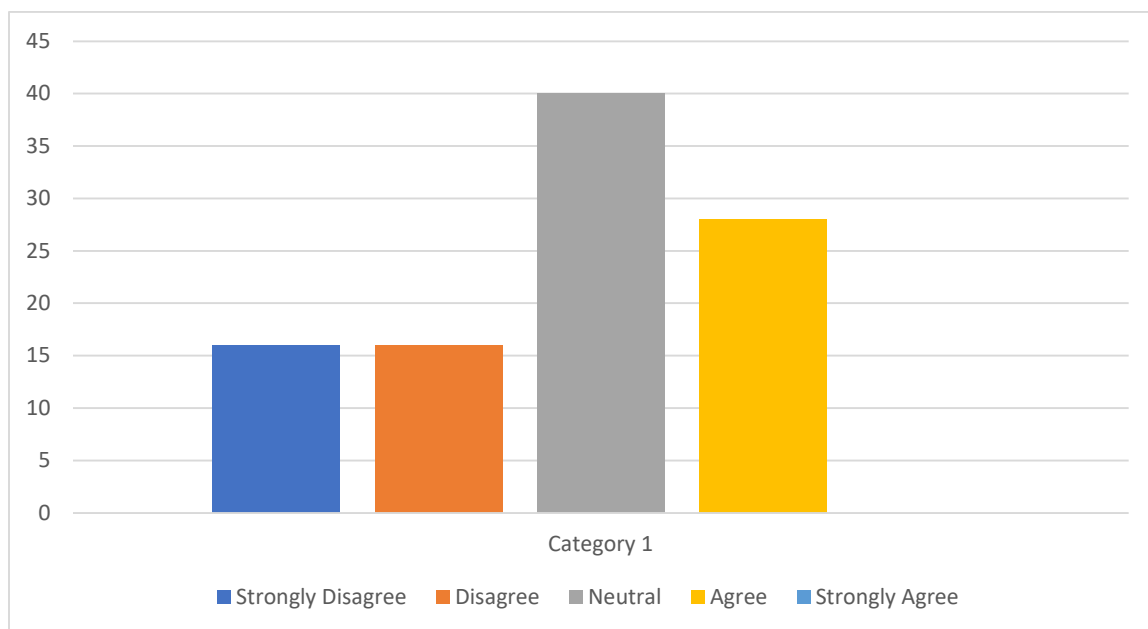
Interpretation: According to the table, 48% of the respondents (36% Agree and 12% Strongly Agree) feel that the ICEGATE portal makes filing and tracking easier for CHA operations. 24% remained neutral, while 28% disagreed. This suggests that a majority find the portal helpful, although a significant portion have differing opinions.

8.Delays in clearance are mainly due to incorrect or incomplete documentation.

TABLE 12

Response	No of respondents	Percentage (%)
Strongly Disagree	4	16%
Disagree	4	16%
Neutral	10	40%
Agree	7	28%
Strongly Agree	0	0
Total	25	100%

CHART 12



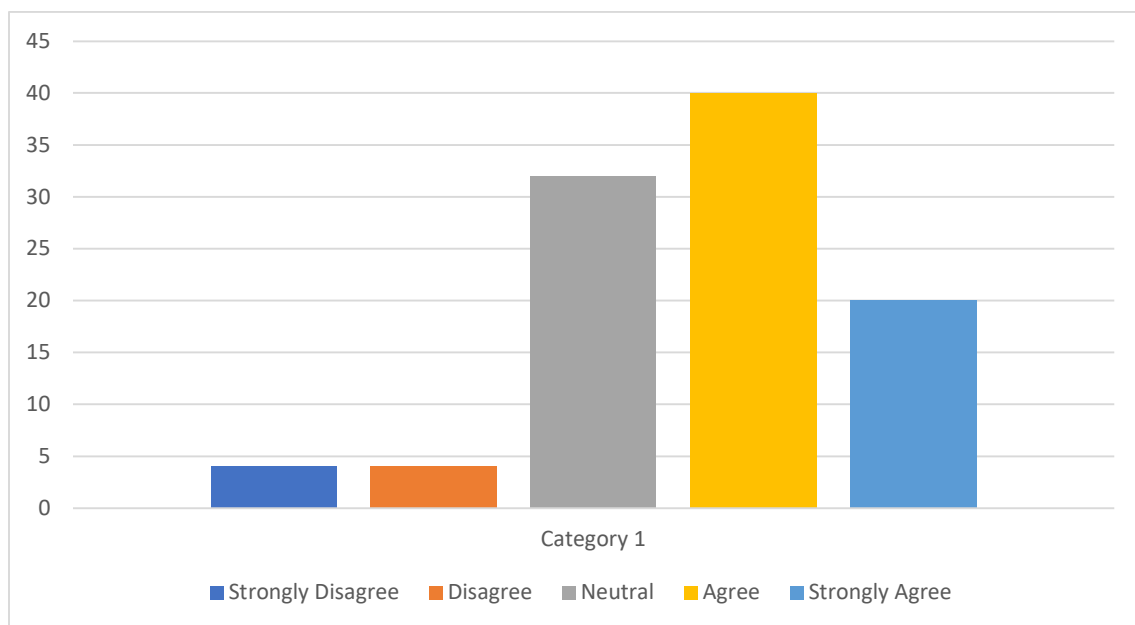
Interpretation: From the table, it is observed that 40% of the respondents remained neutral regarding whether delays in clearance are mainly due to incorrect or incomplete documentation. About 32% (16% Strongly Disagree and 16% Disagree) disagreed with the statement, while 28% agreed. This shows that opinions are mixed, with a large portion being neutral on the issue.

9.The CHA team is well-trained and knowledgeable in customs procedures

TABLE 13

Response	No of respondents	Percentage (%)
Strongly Disagree	1	4%
Disagree	1	4%
Neutral	8	32%
Agree	10	40%
Strongly Agree	5	20%
Total	25	100%

CHART 13



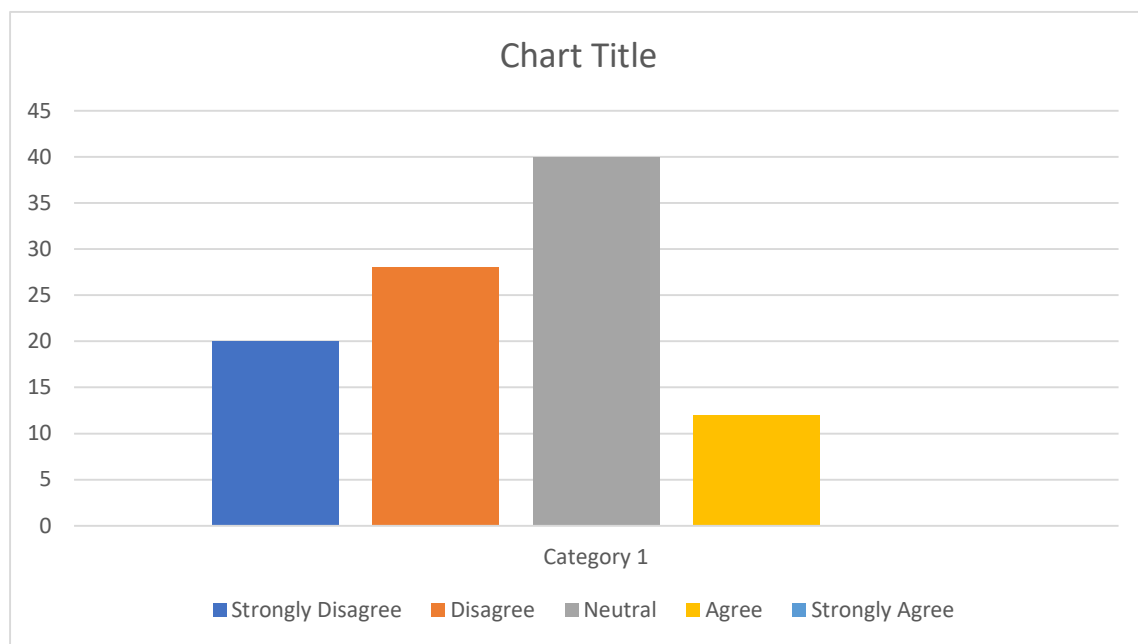
Interpretation: From the table, it is observed that 40% of the respondents remained neutral regarding whether delays in clearance are mainly due to incorrect or incomplete documentation. About 32% (16% Strongly Disagree and 16% Disagree) disagreed with the statement, while 28% agreed. This shows that opinions are mixed, with a large portion being neutral on the issue.

10. There is scope for automation and improvement in current CHA practices.

TABLE 14

Response	No of respondents	Percentage (%)
Strongly Disagree	5	20%
Disagree	7	28%
Neutral	10	40%
Agree	3	12%
Strongly Agree	0	0
Total	25	100%

CHART 14



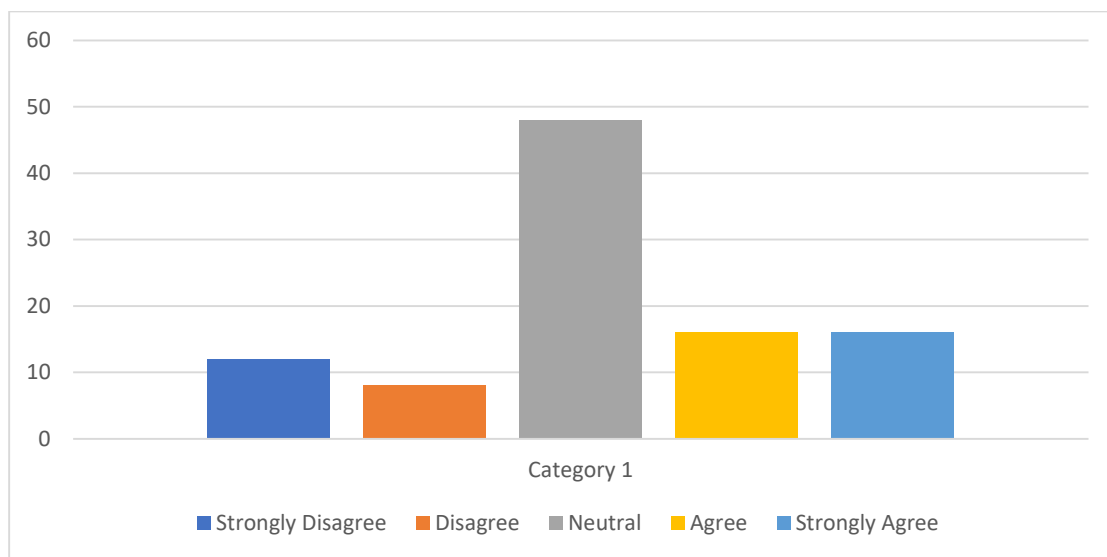
Interpretation: From the table, it is observed that 40% of the respondents remained neutral regarding whether delays in clearance are mainly due to incorrect or incomplete documentation. About 32% (16% Strongly Disagree and 16% Disagree) disagreed with the statement, while 28% agreed. This shows that opinions are mixed, with a large portion being neutral on the issue.

11.Import processes handled by Narpavi face more compliance checks than exports.

TABLE 15

Response	No of respondents	Percentage (%)
Strongly Disagree	3	12%
Disagree	2	8%
Neutral	12	48%
Agree	4	16%
Strongly Agree	4	16%
Total	25	100%

CHART 15



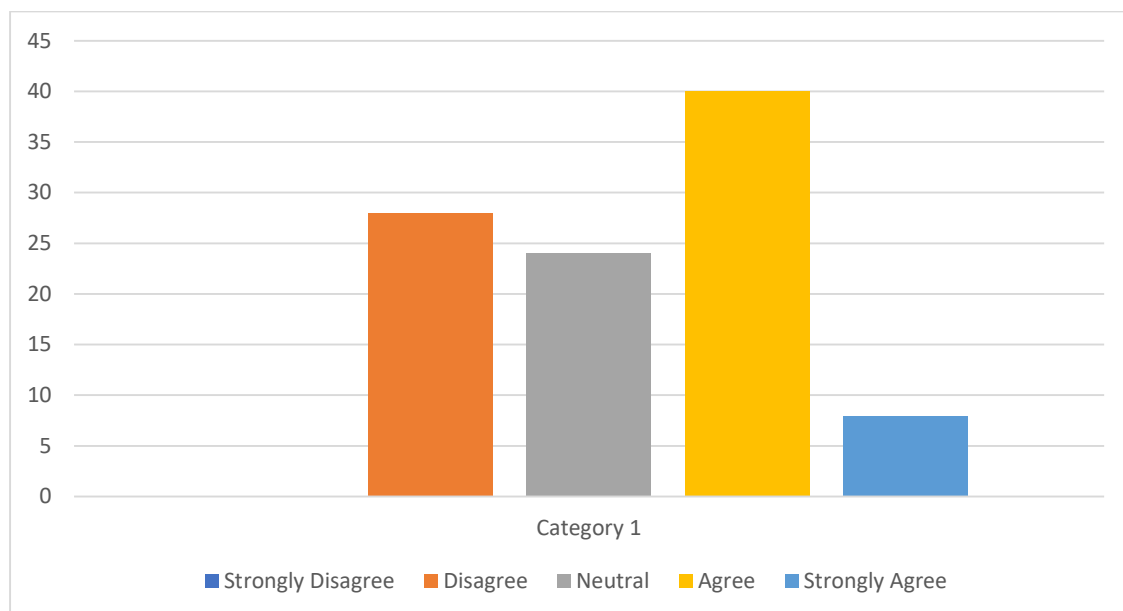
Interpretation: As per the table, 48% of the respondents remained neutral about the statement that import processes handled by Narpavi face more compliance checks than exports. Around 32% (16% Agree and 16% Strongly Agree) agreed, while 20% (12% Strongly Disagree and 8% Disagree) disagreed. This indicates that most respondents are unsure, but a fair number believe imports undergo more compliance checks

12.Clients are satisfied with the customs clearance support offered by Narpavi logistics Pvt. Ltd.,

TABLE 16

Response	No of respondents	Percentage (%)
Strongly Disagree	0	0
Disagree	7	28%
Neutral	6	24%
Agree	10	40%
Strongly Agree	2	8%
Total	25	100%

CHART 16



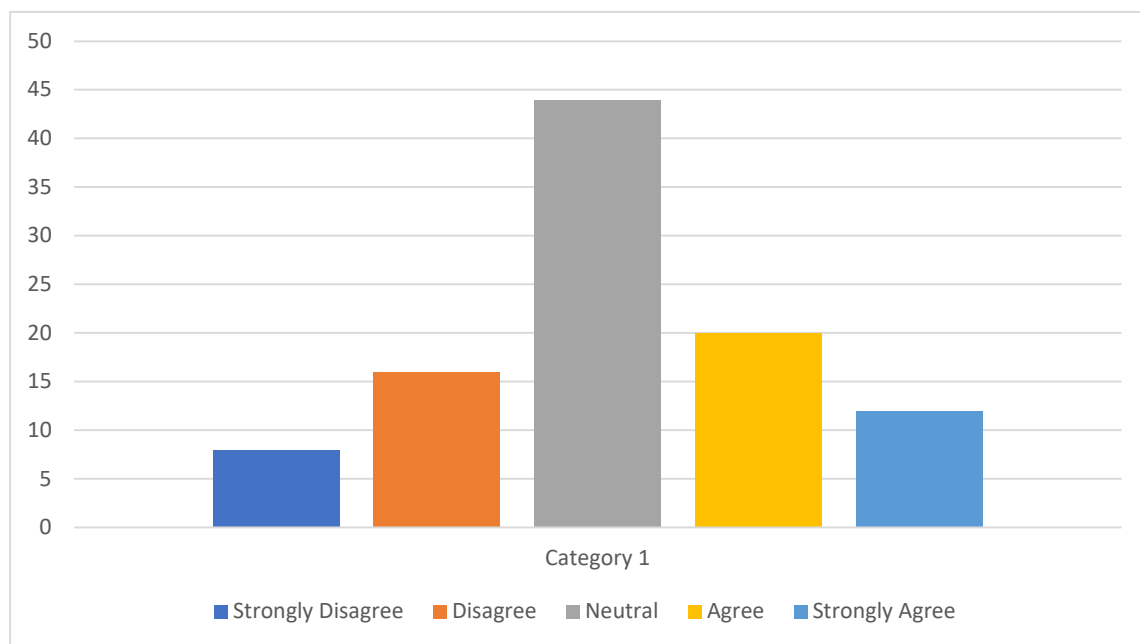
Interpretation: From the table, it is seen that 48% of the respondents (40% Agree and 8% Strongly Agree) feel that clients are satisfied with the customs clearance support offered by Narpavi Logistics Pvt. Ltd. 24% remained neutral, while 28% disagreed. This indicates a generally positive client satisfaction level, though there is still room for improvement.

13.The time taken for customs clearance is reasonable and predictable.

TABLE 17

Response	No of respondents	Percentage (%)
Strongly Disagree	2	8%
Disagree	4	16%
Neutral	11	44%
Agree	5	20%
Strongly Agree	3	12%
Total	25	100%

CHART 17



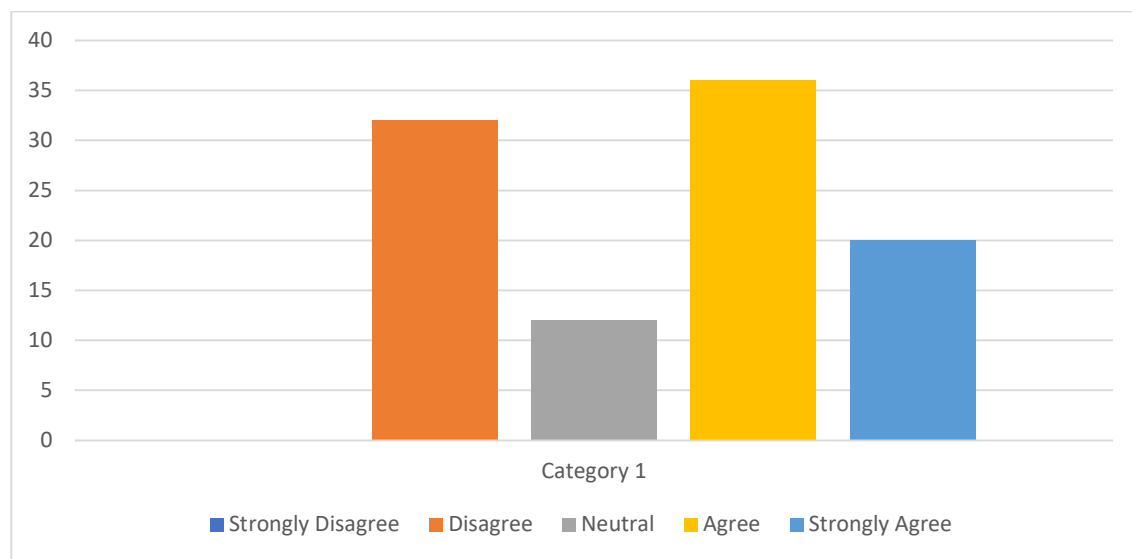
Interpretation: According to the table, 32% of respondents (20% Agree and 12% Strongly Agree) feel that the time taken for customs clearance is reasonable and predictable. However, 44% remained neutral, and 24% (8% Strongly Disagree and 16% Disagree) disagreed. This shows that while some respondents are positive, a large portion are uncertain about the consistency of clearance timings.

14. There is clear internal communication among the CHA/documentation teams

TABLE 18

Response	No of respondents	Percentage (%)
Strongly Disagree	0	0
Disagree	8	32%
Neutral	3	12%
Agree	9	36%
Strongly Agree	5	20%
Total	25	100%

CHART 18



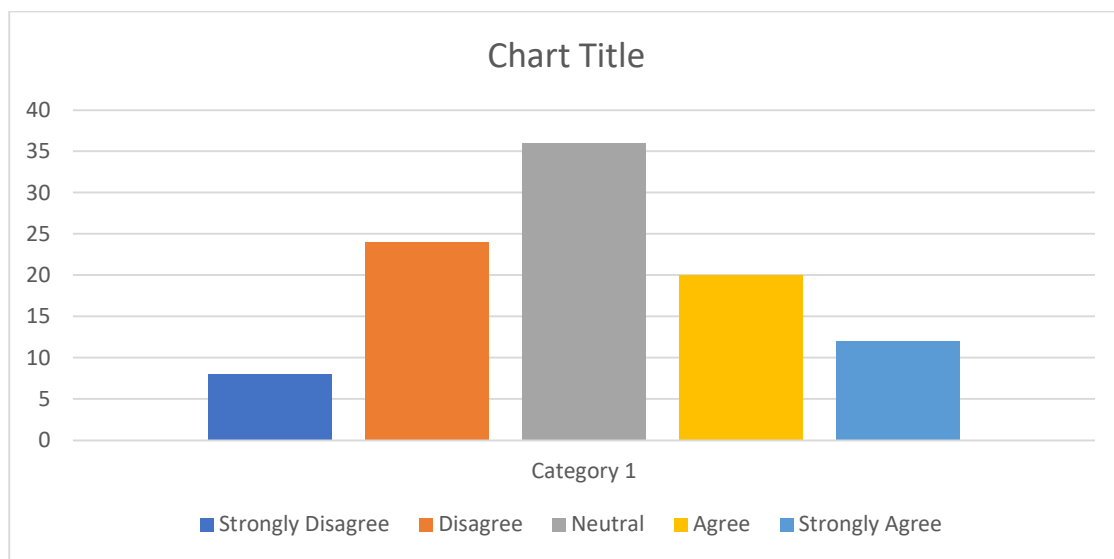
Interpretation: From the table, it is observed that 56% of the respondents (36% Agree and 20% Strongly Agree) feel there is clear internal communication among the CHA and documentation teams. 12% remained neutral, while 32% disagreed. This indicates that a majority view internal communication as effective, though some believe there is room for improvement

15.The company provides regular training for staff to keep up with policy changes.

TABLE 19

Response	No of respondents	Percentage (%)
Strongly Disagree	2	8%
Disagree	6	24%
Neutral	9	36%
Agree	5	20%
Strongly Agree	3	12%
Total	25	100%

CHART 19



Interpretation: As per the table, 32% of the respondents (20% Agree and 12% Strongly Agree) feel that the company provides regular training for staff to keep up with policy changes. However, 36% remained neutral, and 32% (8% Strongly Disagree and 24% Disagree) disagreed. This suggests that while some employees acknowledge training efforts, a considerable number feel improvements are needed

4.2. Chi-Square Test: Association Between Department and Satisfaction Towards CHA Operations

Hypotheses:

Null Hypothesis (H_0): There is no significant association between Department (Import/Export) and Satisfaction towards CHA operations among employees in Narpavi Logistics Pvt Ltd.

Observed Data:

Department	Highly Satisfied (5)	Satisfied (4)	Neutral (3)	Dissatisfied (2)	Highly Dissatisfied (1)	Total
Import	4	5	2	1	0	12
Export	3	5	3	1	1	13
Total	7	10	5	2	1	25

Chi-Square Test Summary:

Statistic	Value
Chi-Square Value (χ^2)	1.416
Degrees of Freedom (df)	4
P-Value	0.841
Significance Level (α)	0.05

Interpretation:

- Decision: Since the P-value (0.841) is much greater than the significance level of 0.05, we fail to reject the null hypothesis.
- Conclusion: There is no significant association between the Department (Import/Export) and Satisfaction towards CHA operations among the employees at Narpavi Logistics Pvt Ltd.

CHAPTER - 5

CHAPTER - V

FINDINGS AND SUGGESTIONS

5.1 FINDINGS

1. **Efficiency of CHA Operations:** 56% of employees agreed that CHA operations at Narpavi Logistics are well-structured and efficient, reflecting a sound operational framework but leaving scope for further strengthening.
2. **Documentation Accuracy:** 84% of respondents acknowledged that the use of FOCUS ERP software has considerably improved documentation accuracy, thereby reducing manual errors and enhancing compliance.
3. **Use of Digital Tools:** Although 48% supported ICEGATE portal usage for ease of filing and tracking, a notable 28% expressed dissatisfaction, pointing towards system challenges or training needs.
4. **Customs Clearance Timeliness:** About 68% of respondents feel customs clearance happens without major delays, indicating effective procedural handling, though 24% remained neutral or dissatisfied.
5. **Coordination with Customs Authorities:** Responses show mixed opinions regarding CHA staff's coordination with customs officials; while 32% agreed positively, 36% expressed dissatisfaction, suggesting inconsistency in relationship management.
6. **Client Communication:** Only 36% of respondents feel clients are regularly updated about shipment status, with 32% disagreeing. This highlights a critical area requiring proactive engagement.
7. **Training and Skill Development:** 32% of employees confirmed receiving regular training, but an equal percentage disagreed, indicating gaps in structured upskilling programs.
8. **Internal Team Communication:** 56% of respondents rated internal communication within CHA/documentation teams as good, which is encouraging but still leaves a 32% dissatisfaction gap.

- 9. Operational Challenges:** Neutral responses dominate regarding documentation challenges between imports and exports, highlighting the need for standardized processes across both areas.
- 10. Employee Experience Levels:** A majority of staff (44%) have more than 3 years of experience, indicating a mature workforce capable of handling complex CHA operations if properly trained.
- 11. Scope for Automation:** Though automation initiatives like FOCUS ERP are appreciated, employees still believe that significant scope remains for further digital transformation to optimize processes.
- 12. Client Satisfaction:** 48% of respondents felt clients are satisfied with customs clearance support, while 24% remained neutral, indicating a need to enhance service quality for higher satisfaction levels.
- 13. Predictability of Clearance Time:** Only 32% agreed that clearance timeframes are reasonable and predictable, implying room for better forecasting and turnaround management.
- 14. Impact of Compliance Checks:** Import shipments were perceived to face slightly higher compliance checks compared to exports, though most responses were neutral, suggesting a need for better process transparency.
- 15. Statistical Test Outcome:** The chi-square test results confirm that satisfaction towards CHA operations does not significantly vary between import and export departments.

5.2 SUGGESTIONS

1. Establish a dedicated customs relationship management team to streamline interactions with customs officers, resolve queries faster, and proactively manage inspection and classification issues.
2. Develop an automated client communication framework integrated with FOCUS ERP, enabling shipment tracking updates and clearance notifications to be sent via email, SMS, or mobile apps at critical stages.
3. Institutionalize a quarterly training calendar covering ERP operations, ICEGATE portal updates, customs law changes, and document preparation best practices to ensure employees stay current and compliant.
4. Form a documentation accuracy and compliance cell responsible for pre-submission verification of all documents, reducing the incidence of classification errors, duty miscalculations, and shipment delays.
5. Expand the adoption of automation by introducing AI-based systems for document vetting, predictive clearance scheduling, and risk profiling to make CHA operations smarter and faster.
6. Create standardized clearance time targets for different shipment types based on historical data, track variances monthly, and optimize operations to deliver predictable clearance durations.
7. Implement a client feedback loop post-clearance using digital surveys to capture service experience ratings, analyze feedback trends, and execute corrective actions where necessary.
8. Strengthen internal communication with dedicated platforms such as Slack or Microsoft Teams for CHA and documentation teams to share real-time updates, status changes, and quick escalations.
9. Launch a digital customs updates bulletin circulated weekly to all employees summarizing important changes in DGFT notifications, ICEGATE announcements, or port-related circulars to ensure proactive compliance.

10. Invest in upskilling employees with internationally recognized logistics certifications (e.g., AEO Certification Training, FIATA Diplomas), building future-ready customs and freight specialists.
11. Design crisis response protocols for system downtimes, regulatory surprises, or port congestions, ensuring uninterrupted service and minimizing operational risks during emergencies.
12. Upgrade IT infrastructure with cloud-based document storage, e-invoicing systems, and electronic customs filing solutions to accelerate document handling and increase traceability.
13. Monitor individual and departmental KPIs like clearance time adherence, document error rate, client satisfaction index, and reward high performers to foster a competitive, quality-driven culture.
14. Promote cross-functional knowledge sharing through internal workshops where experienced employees mentor newer staff, ensuring process wisdom is institutionalized within the organization.
15. Focus on sustainable operations by encouraging paperless documentation, adopting green logistics practices, and supporting customs initiatives towards eco-friendly and digitized trade facilitation.

CONCLUSION

The customs clearance and CHA operations at **Narpavi Logistics Pvt. Ltd.** play a crucial role in ensuring the smooth handling of import and export consignments. The study revealed that the company has a reasonably structured operational framework supported by the usage of modern digital tools like FOCUS ERP and ICEGATE portal. These tools have improved documentation accuracy, reduced manual errors, and enhanced compliance with customs regulations. However, the survey responses also indicated that despite the technological adoption, there are still operational areas that require further attention to achieve greater consistency and efficiency.

It was found that coordination with customs officials, although satisfactory for a section of employees, remains inconsistent across the organization. Similarly, client communication regarding shipment updates is not uniformly practiced, which could potentially impact customer satisfaction levels. The training initiatives currently in place are moderately effective, but the lack of a structured and continuous learning program has created knowledge gaps, particularly in adapting to frequent policy changes and technological advancements. Strengthening internal communication and developing a more proactive culture towards compliance and documentation accuracy would contribute to smoother operations.

The analysis of employee experiences showed no significant difference in satisfaction levels between the import and export departments, indicating that systemic operational challenges are common across functions. Documentation procedures for both imports and exports, though largely efficient, still encounter occasional delays due to document inaccuracies, last-minute clarifications, and coordination gaps. Moreover, while the majority of employees view the time taken for customs clearance as reasonable, the unpredictability of clearance duration for certain shipments suggests that process standardization is necessary.

In conclusion, while Narpavi Logistics Pvt. Ltd. has built a solid foundation in its CHA and customs clearance operations, the company must focus on bridging the gaps through strategic improvements. Enhanced training programs, the deployment of advanced automation technologies, the establishment of a dedicated documentation verification team, and the reinforcement of client communication protocols will be critical steps towards operational excellence. Furthermore, building stronger relations with customs authorities, proactive risk

management, and a future-ready workforce will ensure that the company continues to maintain its competitive edge in the logistics industry.

By adopting these recommendations, Narpavi Logistics Pvt. Ltd. can achieve higher levels of client satisfaction, improve clearance predictability, and solidify its position as a reliable and efficient logistics service provider in the increasingly competitive global trade environment. Continuous process innovation, employee development, and client-centric strategies will be key drivers for the company's sustained growth and success.

APPENDIX

SL.NO	QUESTIONS	SA	A	N	D	SD
Demographic Information						
1	Name					
2	Designation					
3	Gender					
4	Age Group					
5	Years of Experience					
6	Department					
7	The CHA operations at Narpavi Logistics are well-structured and efficient.					
8	Documentation processes for imports are more time-consuming than for exports					
9	The customs clearance process is usually completed without unnecessary delays					
10	CHA staff at Narpavi have good coordination with customs officials.					
11	Clients are regularly updated about the shipment and clearance status					
12	The use of FOCUS ERP software improves the accuracy of documentation.					
13	ICEGATE portal makes filing and tracking easier for CHA operations.					
14	Delays in clearance are mainly due to incorrect or incomplete documentation					
15	The CHA team is well-trained and knowledgeable in customs procedures.					
16	There is scope for automation and improvement in current CHA practices					
17	Import processes handled by Narpavi face more compliance checks than exports					
18	Clients are satisfied with the customs clearance support offered by Narpavi.					
19	The time taken for customs clearance is reasonable and predictable.					
20	There is clear internal communication among the CHA/documentation teams					
21	The company provides regular training for staff to keep up with policy changes.					

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29. Primary Data: Collected through structured questionnaire responses from 25 employees at Narpavi Logistics Pvt. Ltd., Chennai (2025) during the internship period.
30. Secondary Data: Gathered from books, research articles, white papers, internet sources, industry journals, and official government publications related to customs and CHA operations.